

STAR Robot Control System

Comprehensive Technical Documentation

Complete Reference for Software Engineers

Version 1.0
December 2025

STAR Development Team
Locked Inc.

Contents

1	Nanopb (Protobuf) Protocol with ARQ and CRC for SPI Communication	3
1.1	Executive Summary	3
1.1.1	Control Loop Frequency Rationale	3
1.2	Key Design Decisions	4
1.2.1	Protocol Stack	4
1.2.2	Byte Order and Standards Compliance	4
1.2.3	Memory Budget	5
1.3	Implementation Requirements	6
1.3.1	Protocol Stack Architecture	6
1.3.2	RX72N (SPI Peripheral) Implementation	6
1.3.3	RPi5 (SPI Controller) Implementation	7
1.3.4	ARQ Symmetry and State Management	8
1.3.5	Example Transaction: RPi5 Sends Velocity Command	9
1.4	ARQ Communication Flow	9
1.4.1	Normal Operation (No Retransmission)	10
1.4.2	Error Recovery Scenarios	10
1.5	Error Handling Strategies	12
2	Protocol Buffer Schema Architecture	13
2.1	Architecture Overview	13
2.2	Service Specifications	13
2.2.1	MotorControlService	13
2.2.2	TelemetryService	14
2.2.3	BatteryManagementService	15
2.2.4	ConfigurationService	15
2.3	common.proto – Shared Types	16
2.4	Code Generation and Integration	16
3	Hardware Pin Connections	17
3.1	RX72N Microcontroller Pinout (R5F572NNHGFP#30)	17
3.2	Raspberry Pi 5 Pinout	20
3.3	Additional Peripheral Connections	20
4	Protocol Buffer Style Guide	21
4.1	Terminology Standard	21
4.2	Protocol Buffer Naming Conventions (Boston Dynamics Style)	21
4.3	Unit Suffixes (MKS System)	21
4.4	General Documentation Standards	22
4.5	NASA Power of 10: Rules for Safety-Critical Code	22
4.5.1	Compliance Status Legend	22
4.5.2	Rule 1: Simplify Control Flow	22
4.5.3	Rule 2: Fixed Loop Upper-Bounds	23
4.5.4	Rule 3: No Dynamic Memory After Initialization	23
4.5.5	Rule 4: Keep Functions Short	24
4.5.6	Rule 5: Use Assertions Generously	24
4.5.7	Rule 6: Declare Data at Smallest Scope	25

4.5.8	Rule 7: Check All Return Values and Parameters	25
4.5.9	Rule 8: Limit Preprocessor Use	26
4.5.10	Rule 9: Restrict Pointer Use	27
4.5.11	Rule 10: Compile with Maximum Warnings	27
4.5.12	Summary: STAR Compliance Matrix	28
4.5.13	References	28
5	Gateway Architecture	29
5.1	Overview	29
5.2	Protocol Stack Implementation	29
5.3	Directory Structure	29
5.4	Frame Package	30
5.4.1	Frame Constants	30
5.4.2	Frame Types	30
5.5	Transport Package	30
5.5.1	SPI Configuration	31
5.5.2	Transport Interface	31
5.6	ARQ Package	31
5.6.1	ARQ Parameters	31
5.6.2	ARQ State Machine	31
5.7	gRPC Services	31
5.8	Build and Test	32
5.9	Dependencies	32

1 Nanopb (Protobuf) Protocol with ARQ and CRC for SPI Communication

1.1 Executive Summary

Overview: Protocol Buffers (nanopb) encapsulated in frames with CRC-32 and Automatic Repeat Request (ARQ) for reliable SPI communication between RPi5 and RX72N.



System Constraints:

- Renesas RX72N: 4MB flash, 1MB SRAM
- 100Hz SPI communication (10ms period)
- 250Hz motor control loop (4ms period)
- Static allocation only (no malloc)

1.1.1 Control Loop Frequency Rationale

Why different loop rates?

The nested loop architecture follows classic control systems design. The outer loop (SPI at 100Hz) handles command distribution and telemetry collection, while the inner loop (PID at 250Hz) responds quickly to motor dynamics. Running PID at 2.5 times the communication rate ensures smooth control between commands without wasting CPU on excessive computation.

Why 250Hz for motor control?

This is a Nyquist sampling consideration. With DC gearmotors at 210 RPM (3.5 Hz mechanical speed) and a first-order time constant $\tau = 75$ ms (cutoff frequency $f_c = 1/(2\pi\tau) \approx 2.1$ Hz), the 250Hz control rate provides approximately 60 times oversampling of the mechanical dynamics - well above the 2 times Nyquist minimum.

Running at 250Hz balances:

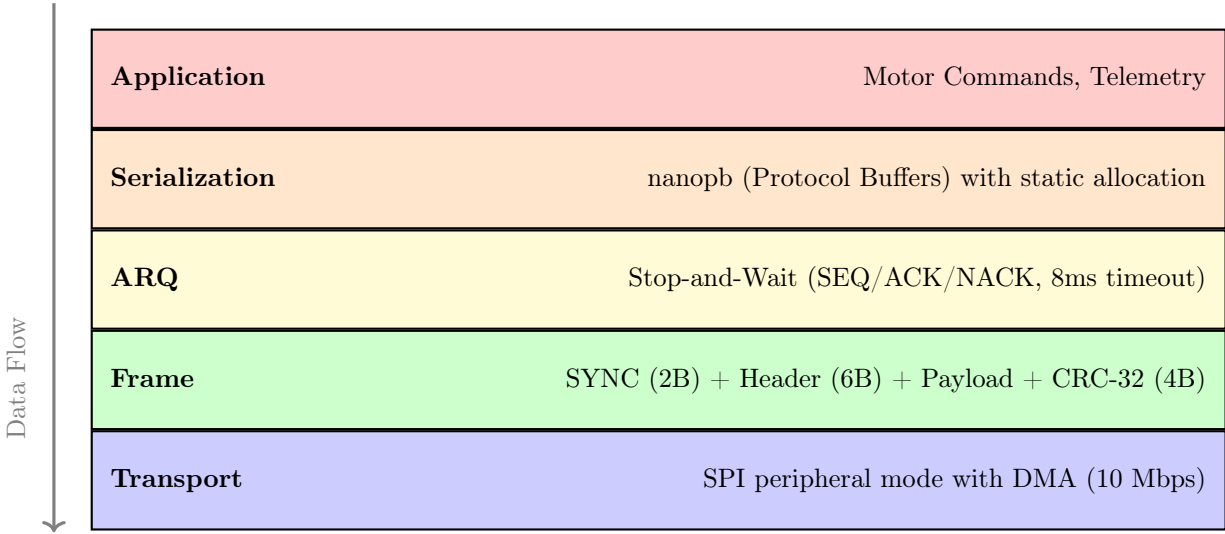
- Adequate sampling of motor dynamics (60 times oversampling)
- Efficient CPU utilization (4 motors $\times$ PID + encoder reads)
- Low latency between velocity commands and motor response
- Power efficiency (fewer ADC conversions, GPIO reads, and computations)

For context, control loop frequencies should match system dynamics:

- DC gearmotors: 50-500 Hz typical
- High-speed servos: 1-10 kHz
- Motor current control: 10-50 kHz
- Temperature control: 0.1-10 Hz

1.2 Key Design Decisions

1.2.1 Protocol Stack



1.2.2 Byte Order and Standards Compliance

The protocol follows established standards for byte ordering to ensure cross-platform compatibility:

Table 1: Byte Order Standards by Protocol Field

Field	Byte Order	Standard	Rationale
SYNC	Big-endian	RFC 1700	Network byte order for headers
SEQ	Big-endian	RFC 1700	Network byte order for headers
LEN	Big-endian	RFC 1700	Network byte order for headers
TYPE	N/A (1 byte)	–	Single byte, no endianness
FLAGS	N/A (1 byte)	–	Single byte, no endianness
CRC-32	Little-endian	IEEE 802.3	Standard CRC-32 polynomial

SYNC Magic Word (0x55AA): The frame synchronization marker uses the distinctive bit pattern 0x55AA (binary: 0101010101010101 in big-endian wire format). This alternating pattern is easily recognizable and unlikely to appear in random data, making it ideal for frame alignment. The value 0x55AA is transmitted as bytes [0x55, 0xAA] on the wire.

RFC 1700 (Network Byte Order): All multi-byte header fields (SYNC, SEQ, LEN) use big-endian format following RFC 1700 “Assigned Numbers” standard. This ensures compatibility when communicating between different architectures (ARM RPi5 and Renesas RX72N, both little-endian internally).

IEEE 802.3 (CRC-32): The frame checksum uses IEEE 802.3 polynomial (0x04C11DB7) in little-endian format, compatible with standard Ethernet CRC libraries. This allows zero-copy CRC validation using hardware accelerators where available.

Key Insight: Mixed byte orders are intentional — headers follow network standards for cross-platform compatibility, while CRC follows IEEE 802.3 for hardware acceleration and library compatibility.

1.2.3 Memory Budget

Table 2: SRAM Usage (512 KB total)

Component	Size (KB)	Usage (%)
DMA double-buffer	8.0	1.56
RX/TX buffers	2.0	0.39
Protobuf structs	1.5	0.29
ARQ state	4.0	0.78
Total	15.5	3.03

Table 3: Flash Usage (16 MB total)

Component	Size (KB)	Usage (%)
Generated protobuf	80	0.49
Nanopb runtime	12	0.07
Frame + ARQ layers	8	0.05
Total	100	0.61

Memory Budget Calculations:

SRAM (512 KB total):

- **DMA double-buffer:** 2×4092 bytes = 8184 bytes = 8.0 KB
Calculation: Two ping-pong DMA buffers at `STAR_SPI_DMA_MAX_SIZE` (4092 bytes each)
Usage: $\frac{8.0}{512} \times 100 = 1.56\%$
- **RX/TX buffers:** $1024 + 1024 = 2048$ bytes = 2.0 KB
Calculation: 1 KB RX buffer + 1 KB TX buffer for staging protobuf messages
Usage: $\frac{2.0}{512} \times 100 = 0.39\%$
- **Protobuf structs:** 1536 bytes = 1.5 KB
Calculation: Largest message structures (SetVelocityResponse $\approx$ 600 bytes, TelemetryData $\approx$ 400 bytes)
Usage: $\frac{1.5}{512} \times 100 = 0.29\%$
- **ARQ state:** $4 + 4 + 8 + 4 + 4092 = 4112$ bytes $\approx$ 4.0 KB
Calculation: Sequence number (4B) + retry counter (4B) + timestamp (8B) + state (4B) + retry buffer (4092B)
Usage: $\frac{4.0}{512} \times 100 = 0.78\%$
- **Total SRAM:** $8.0 + 2.0 + 1.5 + 4.0 = 15.5$ KB
Total usage: $\frac{15.5}{512} \times 100 = 3.03\%$

Flash (16 MB = 16384 KB total):

- **Generated protobuf:** 80 KB
Calculation: 6 proto files (common, motor_control, telemetry, battery_management, configuration, firmware_update) $\times$ 13 KB avg compiled size
Usage: $\frac{80}{16384} \times 100 = 0.49\%$
- **Nanopb runtime:** 12 KB
Calculation: Compiled size of pb_encode.c, pb_decode.c, pb_common.c
Usage: $\frac{12}{16384} \times 100 = 0.07\%$
- **Frame + ARQ layers:** 8 KB
Calculation: Framing logic + CRC-32 + ARQ state machine + retransmission logic
Usage: $\frac{8}{16384} \times 100 = 0.05\%$
- **Total Flash:** $80 + 12 + 8 = 100$ KB
Total usage: $\frac{100}{16384} \times 100 = 0.61\%$

1.3 Implementation Requirements

1.3.1 Protocol Stack Architecture

The protocol is implemented as a layered stack on both the RPi5 (SPI controller) and RX72N (SPI peripheral). Each layer has specific responsibilities:

Layer	Responsibility	Implementation
5. Application	Motor commands, telemetry, control logic	Different per platform
4. Protobuf	Message encode/decode (nanopb)	Both sides
3. ARQ	Sequence numbering, ACK/NACK, retry logic	Both sides (symmetric)
2. Framing	Header/footer, CRC-32 verification	Both sides (identical)
1. SPI+DMA	Physical transport with double-buffering	Both sides (different roles)

Table 4: Protocol stack layers and implementation requirements

Key Insight: Layers 2-4 are nearly identical on both platforms. Only the application layer (Layer 5) and SPI role (Layer 1: controller vs peripheral) differ.

1.3.2 RX72N (SPI Peripheral) Implementation

Layer 1: SPI Peripheral with DMA

- Configure RSPI in peripheral mode
- Set up DMA with double-buffering: 2×4092 bytes
- Register DMA interrupt callbacks for buffer swapping
- Wait for chip select from RPi5, respond to clock

Layer 2: Frame Layer (Custom Code)

RX Path:

- Parse frame header (magic bytes, length, sequence number)
- Verify CRC-32 over header + payload
- If CRC fails → discard packet, send NACK
- If CRC valid → extract payload, pass to ARQ layer

TX Path:

- Build frame: [Header | Payload | CRC32 | Footer]
- Calculate CRC-32 over header + payload
- Queue complete frame to DMA buffer for transmission

Layer 3: ARQ Layer (Custom Code)

RX Path:

- Check sequence number against `last_acked_rx`
- If duplicate (`seq ≤ last_acked_rx`) → send ACK, discard payload
- If expected (`seq = last_acked_rx + 1`) → accept, send ACK
- If out-of-order → send NACK, request retransmission

TX Path:

- Assign `tx_sequence_number` to outgoing frame
- Store frame in retry buffer
- Start timeout timer (e.g., 10ms)
- On timeout → retransmit (up to 3 attempts)
- On ACK received → clear retry buffer, increment `tx_seq`

Layer 4: Protobuf (nanopb library)

- Decode incoming bytes → `SetVelocityRequest`, `EmergencyStopRequest`
- Encode outgoing structs → `SetVelocityResponse`, `TelemetryData`
- Uses `star.v1` package following Boston Dynamics style guide
- Static allocation (no malloc) with `.options` file constraints

Layer 5: Application

- Handle motor velocity commands
- Read encoder data via multiplexer
- Execute PID control loop (250 Hz per motor)
- Send telemetry responses (encoder feedback, current, temperature)

1.3.3 RPi5 (SPI Controller) Implementation

Layer 1: SPI Controller with DMA

- Use Linux `/dev/spidev` interface
- Configure SPI3: 10 Mbps, mode 0, 8-bit words
- Use `ioctl(SPI_IOC_MESSAGE)` for DMA transfers
- Implement userspace double-buffering for continuous operation

Layer 2: Frame Layer (*Custom Code - SAME AS RX72N*)

RX Path: Parse frame header, verify CRC-32, extract payload or discard on CRC failure

TX Path: Build frame [`Header` | `Payload` | `CRC32` | `Footer`], calculate CRC-32, send via SPI

Layer 3: ARQ Layer (*Custom Code - SAME AS RX72N*)

RX Path: Check sequence number, detect duplicates → ACK and discard, detect out-of-order → NACK

TX Path: Assign sequence number, store in retry buffer, timeout and retry logic, handle ACKs

Layer 4: Protobuf (Go with protoc-gen-go)

- Encode: `SetVelocityRequest`, `EmergencyStopRequest`
- Decode: `SetVelocityResponse`, `TelemetryData`, `EncoderData`
- Uses `star.v1` package following Boston Dynamics style guide

Layer 5: Application (star-gateway)

- Send motor velocity commands from Nav2 (autonomous) or UI (manual)
- All control flows through Nav2 stack for consistent behavior
- Receive encoder feedback for odometry calculations
- Bridge ROS2 topics to/from RX72N via SPI

1.3.4 ARQ Symmetry and State Management

The ARQ layer uses **Stop-and-Wait** protocol (also called alternating bit protocol). This means each side sends one frame at a time, waits for acknowledgment (ACK) with a timeout, and retries up to 3 times before declaring failure. This approach provides:

- Simple implementation suitable for embedded systems
- Predictable worst-case latency for real-time control
- Low memory overhead (single retry buffer, not a window of frames)
- Sufficient throughput for 10 Mbps SPI with <1ms frame time

The ARQ protocol is **symmetric** — both sides implement identical Stop-and-Wait logic but maintain separate state for their own transmissions and receptions.

Each Side Maintains:

- **TX sequence number** (`tx_seq`): For packets it sends
- **RX last acknowledged** (`rx_last_ack`): For packets it receives
- **Retry buffer**: Stores unacknowledged outgoing packets
- **Timeout timer**: Triggers retransmission if no ACK received

Responsibility	RX72N (Peripheral)	RPi5 (Controller)
Sends	Telemetry, responses	Commands, requests
TX sequence numbering	Own <code>tx_seq</code>	Own <code>tx_seq</code>
ACK/NACK generation	Sends ACK for RPi5	Sends ACK for RX72N
Retry logic	Retries if no ACK	Retries if no ACK
Duplicate detection	Checks RPi5's <code>seq</code>	Checks RX72N's <code>seq</code>

Table 5: ARQ role distribution between controller and peripheral

Important: The SPI controller/peripheral roles (Layer 1) are **hardware-level only**. The ARQ layer (Layer 3) treats both sides as equals — each can send, ACK, and retry independently.

1.3.5 Example Transaction: RPi5 Sends Velocity Command

1. **RPi5 Application:** Create `SetVelocityRequest` (left=1.0 m/s, right=1.0 m/s)
2. **RPi5 Protobuf:** Encode to binary (nanopb)
3. **RPi5 ARQ:** Assign `seq=42`, save to retry buffer, start 10ms timeout
4. **RPi5 Frame:** Build packet with header, CRC-32, footer
5. **RPi5 SPI:** DMA transfer to RX72N (controller initiates)
6. **RX72N SPI:** DMA receives packet in double-buffer
7. **RX72N Frame:** Verify CRC-32 → valid
8. **RX72N ARQ:** Check `seq=42 = rx_last_ack+1` → accept
9. **RX72N Protobuf:** Decode to `SetVelocityRequest` struct
10. **RX72N Application:** Update motor setpoints, execute PID control
11. **RX72N ARQ:** Build ACK packet with `ack_seq=42`
12. **RX72N Frame:** Wrap ACK in frame with CRC-32
13. **RX72N SPI:** DMA transmits ACK (peripheral responds)
14. **RPi5 SPI:** DMA receives ACK packet
15. **RPi5 Frame:** Verify CRC-32 → valid
16. **RPi5 ARQ:** Got ACK(42) → clear retry buffer, cancel timeout

Outcome: Command successfully delivered with guaranteed delivery via ARQ. If ACK was lost or CRC failed, RPi5 would retransmit after 10ms timeout.

1.4 ARQ Communication Flow

1.4.1 Normal Operation (No Retransmission)

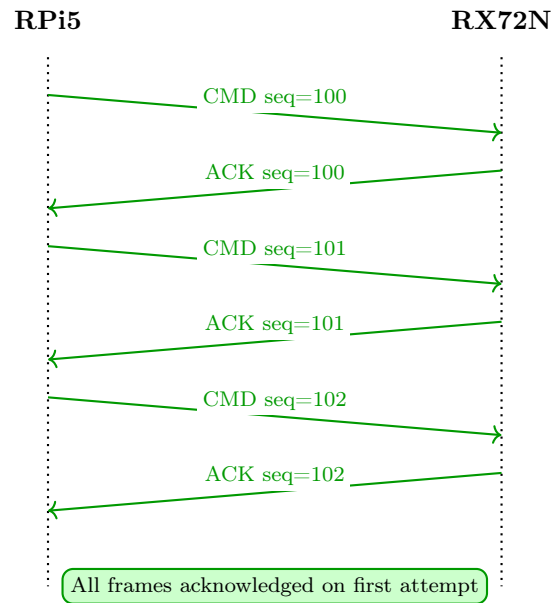


Figure 1: Normal ARQ Flow - Three Successful Transactions

1.4.2 Error Recovery Scenarios

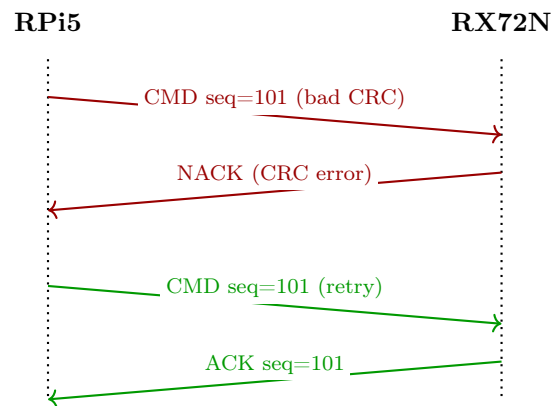


Figure 2: CRC Error - Retry with Same Sequence Number

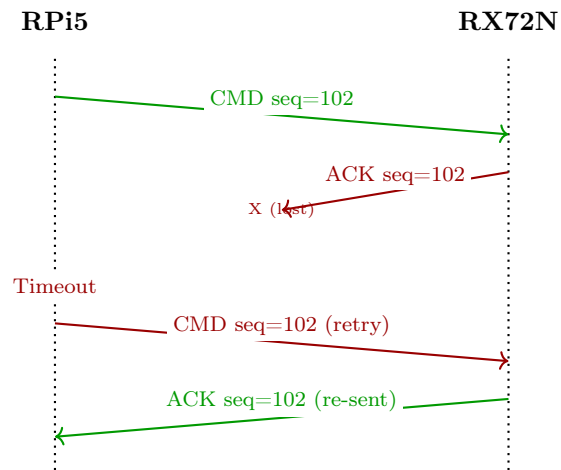


Figure 3: Duplicate Packet Scenario (Lost ACK)

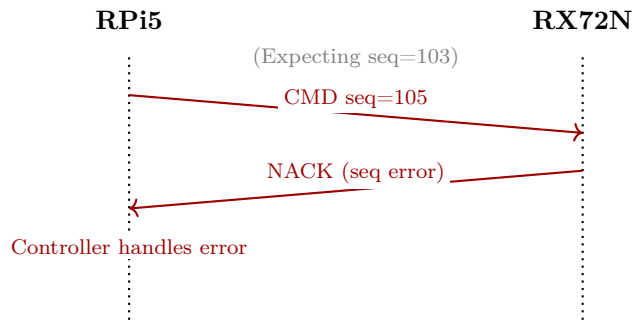


Figure 4: Out-of-Order Packet Scenario

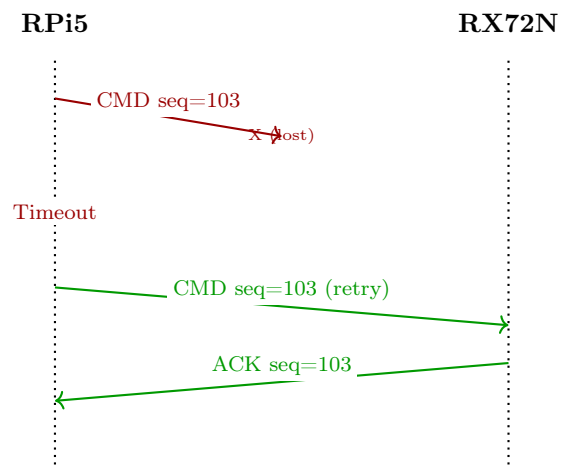


Figure 5: Lost Packet Scenario (Timeout)

1.5 Error Handling Strategies

CRC Mismatch

Action: NACK with CRC error reason
Recovery: Controller retry
Logging: Increment crc_errors

Sequence Error

Duplicate: Re-send ACK
Out-of-order: NACK + reject
Recovery: Controller retry

Timeout

RX timeout: Continue next cycle
500ms watchdog: Emergency stop
Retry fail: Log error

Invalid Protobuf

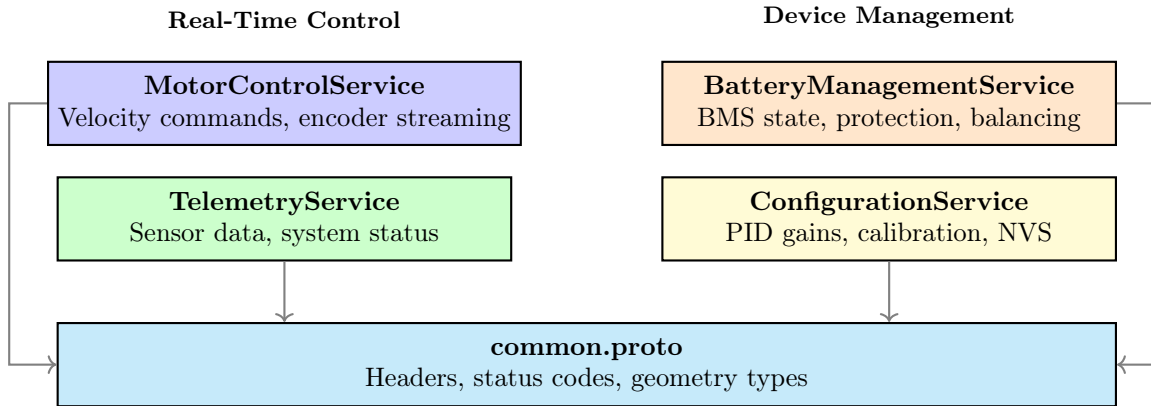
Action: NACK protocol error
Validate: IDs, ranges, offsets
Logging: Increment proto_errors

2 Protocol Buffer Schema Architecture

This section documents the Protocol Buffer schema architecture for RPi5↔RX72N communication. All schemas follow the **Boston Dynamics Protobuf Style Guide** for consistency, maintainability, and industry best practices.

2.1 Architecture Overview

Overview: Five gRPC services define the complete API surface for robot control, organized by functional domain. Services communicate via the nanopb-serialized frames described in Section 1.



Key Design Principles

- **Versioned Package:** All services use `star.v1` namespace for API evolution
- **Request/Response Headers:** Every RPC includes tracing, timestamps, and status
- **Streaming Support:** Continuous data uses server streaming (up to 100Hz)
- **Static Allocation:** All messages sized for nanopb constraints (no dynamic memory)

Note: Naming conventions, unit suffixes, and coding standards are consolidated in Section 4 (Style Guide and Conventions).

2.2 Service Specifications

2.2.1 MotorControlService

Purpose: Low-latency differential drive control with real-time encoder feedback.

Target Latency: <10ms round-trip for velocity commands.

Table 6: MotorControlService RPCs

RPC	Type	Description
SetVelocity	Unary	Set left/right wheel velocities (m/s)
EmergencyStop	Unary	Immediate stop, priority over all commands
SetMotorPower	Unary	Direct PWM control (bypass PID, testing only)
StreamEncoders	Server stream	Encoder ticks and velocity at 1-100Hz
ControlStream	Bidirectional	Velocity in, encoder feedback out

Key Messages:

- **VelocityCommand** – Left/right velocity (m/s), sequence number, timestamp
- **EncoderData** – Motor ID, tick count (341.2 PPR), velocity, timestamp
- **MotorStatus** – Duty cycle, velocity, temperature, current, fault flags
- **PidConfig** – Kp, Ki, Kd gains with output saturation limits

2.2.2 TelemetryService

Purpose: Real-time sensor data aggregation and system health monitoring.

Table 7: TelemetryService RPCs

RPC	Type	Description
GetTelemetry	Unary	Snapshot of all sensor data
StreamTelemetry	Server stream	Continuous sensor updates at 1-100Hz
GetSystemStatus	Unary	Firmware version, uptime, connection states

Key Messages:

- **TelemetryData** – IMU, GPS, battery %, WiFi signal, CPU usage, temperature
- **ImuData** – Pitch/roll/yaw (rad), acceleration (m/s^2), angular velocity (rad/s)
- **GpsData** – Lat/lon (degrees), altitude (m), accuracy, satellite count, fix type
- **SystemStatus** – Connection states, operating mode, free heap, uptime

Enumerations:

- **RobotMode** – IDLE, MANUAL, AUTONOMOUS, MAPPING, EMERGENCY_STOP
- **ConnectionStatus** – CONNECTED, DISCONNECTED, CONNECTING, ERROR
- **GpsFix** – NONE, 2D, 3D, DGPS, RTK_FLOAT, RTK_FIXED

2.2.3 BatteryManagementService

Purpose: BQ7850 BMS monitoring for lithium-ion battery pack safety and management.

Hardware: TI BQ7850 16-cell BMS with I2C interface.

Table 8: BatteryManagementService RPCs

RPC	Type	Description
GetBatteryState	Unary	Complete battery snapshot (cells, temps, SOC)
StreamBatteryState	Server stream	Continuous battery monitoring
Get/SetProtectionThresholds	Unary	OV/UV/OC/OT protection limits
Enable/DisableCellBalancing	Unary	Per-cell passive balancing control
ControlFets	Unary	Charge/discharge FET enable/disable
GetDeviceInfo	Unary	Manufacturer, serial, chemistry, versions

Key Messages:

- **BatteryState** – Composite of all battery data
- **CellData** – Individual cell voltages (mV), pack voltage, valid cell count
- **BatteryTemperatureData** – Thermistor readings (0.1°C), average
- **StateOfChargeData** – Relative/absolute SOC (%), capacity (mAh), cycle count
- **ProtectionThresholds** – OV/UV voltage limits, OC current limits, OT temperatures

2.2.4 ConfigurationService

Purpose: Runtime parameter management with NVS persistence across power cycles.

Table 9: ConfigurationService RPCs

RPC	Type	Description
GetConfiguration	Unary	Read current system configuration
SetConfiguration	Unary	Apply configuration (optional NVS persist)
ResetToDefaults	Unary	Restore factory defaults
ValidateConfiguration	Unary	Validate without applying
SaveConfiguration	Unary	Persist in-memory config to NVS
Get/SetMotorPidConfig	Unary	Per-motor PID tuning

Key Messages:

- **SystemConfiguration** – Complete config with version and CRC32
- **MotorPidConfig** – Per-motor PID gains (4 motors supported)
- **CurrentSensorCalibration** – Offset and scale for current sensing
- **SafetyThresholds** – Overcurrent, thermal shutdown, cell imbalance limits
- **TimingConfig** – Motor period, telemetry period, communication timeout

2.3 common.proto – Shared Types

All services import `common.proto` for standardized request/response handling.

Table 10: Standard Headers

Message	Fields
RequestHeader	request_id (UUID), client_timestamp, client_version, timeout
ResponseHeader	request_id (echo), server_timestamp, status, error_message, latency_us

Status Codes: UNKNOWN, OK, INVALID_REQUEST, INTERNAL_ERROR, NOT_FOUND, TIMEOUT, INVALID_STATE, ESTOP_ACTIVE

Geometric Types:

- **Vector3** – Generic 3D vector (x, y, z)
- **Quaternion** – Orientation (w, x, y, z)
- **SE2Pose** – 2D pose (x_m, y_m, angle_rad)
- **SE2Velocity** – 2D velocity (vx_mps, vy_mps, omega_rad_per_s)

2.4 Code Generation and Integration

Table 11: Code Generation Targets

Target	Generator	Output	Usage
Go	protoc-gen-go + grpc	gen/go/	star-gateway (RPi5)
nanopb	nanopb_generator	gen/nanopb/	RX72N firmware

nanopb Constraints: RX72N requires static allocation. Field sizes are configured in `.options` files:

- String fields: `max_size:64` (request_id), `max_size:128` (error_message)
- Repeated fields: `max_count:16` (cell voltages), `max_count:4` (motors)
- Bytes fields: `max_size:1024` (firmware chunks)

Build Integration:

- **Linting:** `buf lint` enforces style guide compliance
- **Breaking Changes:** `buf breaking` detects API incompatibilities
- **CI Pipeline:** Automatic generation and testing on PR

3 Hardware Pin Connections

3.1 RX72N Microcontroller Pinout (R5F572NNHGFP#30)

Pin	Pin Name	Connected To	Note/Comment
1	AVCC1	Bypass caps	
2	EMLE	Emulator Configuration jumper	See Table 13
3	AVSS1	Ground	
4	PJ3		
5	VCL	220nF cap to ground	
6	VBATT	Boards 3v3	
7	MD/FINED	E1E2-Emulator-Interface, DIP switch	See Table 14. Default: OFF,OFF
8	XCIN	10k resistor to ground	RTC crystal input (not used)
9	XCOUT	Floating	Left floating per datasheet
10	RES#	E1E2-Emulator-Interface, Reset button	MCU reset
11	P37/XTAL	24MHz crystal (to pin 13)	System clock crystal
12	VSS	Ground	
13	P36/EXTAL	24MHz crystal (to pin 11)	System clock crystal
14	VCC	Boards 3v3	
15	P35/NMI/UPSEL	UPSEL configuration jumper	Can be used for NMI (not currently used). See Table 15
16	P34/TST#	E1E2-Emulator-Interface	
17	P33	RES#, CY7C65213A-28PVXI	USB to UART IC for flashing (resets system before firmware flash). See Table 16
18			
19	P31/TMS	E1E2-Emulator-Interface	
20	P30/TDI	E1E2-Emulator-Interface	
21	P27/TCK	E1E2-Emulator-Interface	
22	P26/TDO	E1E2-Emulator-Interface	
23			
24			
25			
26			
27			
28			
29			
30	P16/USB0_VBUS	USB0 VBUS	
31			
32			
33			
34			
35	VCC_USB	Boards 3v3	
36	USB0_DM	USB0 DN (27R resistor)	

Continued on next page

Pin	Pin Name	Connected To	Note/Comment
37	USB0_DP	USB0 DP (27R resistor)	
38	VSS_USB	Ground	
39			
40			
41			
42			
43			
44			
45	PC7/UB	E1E2-Emulator-Interface, DIP switch	Operation mode configuration. See Table 14
46			
47			
48			
49			
50			
51			
52			
53	PB7/TXD9	Debug SCI USB-C RX	UART crossed. See Table 17
54	PB6/RXD9	Debug SCI USB-C TX	UART crossed. See Table 17
55			
56			
57			
58			
59			
60	VCC	Boards 3v3	
61			
62	VSS	Ground	
63			
64			
65			
66			
67			
68			
69			
70			
71			
72			
73			
74			
75			
76			
77			
78			
79			

Continued on next page

Pin	Pin Name	Connected To	Note/Comment
80			
81			
82			
83			
84			
85			
86			
87			
88			
89			
90			
91			
92			
93			
94			
95			
96			
97			
98			
99			
100			

Table 13: Emulator Configuration Jumper Settings

Jumper Position	Configuration
Shorted Pin 1-2 (normal Operation)	E1/E2 Lite normal debugging (use this mode for normal operation). Microcontroller single operation (without emulator)
Shorted Pin 2-3 (debug with E1/E2)	E1/E2 Lite debugging with Hot plug-in
All open	DO NOT SET

Table 14: Operation Configuration Mode DIP Switch Settings

Note: There are 2 USB-C ports. To flash we can use the SCI boot mode if we want to flash with the SCI USB-C. To flash we can use the USB0 boot mode if we want to flash with the USB0 USB-C.

Pin1	Pin2	UPSEL_CFG	OP Mode
OFF	X	X	Single Chip Mode
ON	OFF	X	SCI Boot Mode (SCI1)
ON	ON	1/2	USB (Bus Powered) (USB0)
ON	ON	2/3	USB (Self Powered) (USB0)

Table 15: UPSEL Power Configuration for USB Boot Mode

Jumper Position	Power Configuration for USB Boot Mode
Shorted Pin 1-2 (No battery pack)	Bus Powered
Shorted Pin 2-3 (Battery Pack)	Self Powered

Table 16: Required Pin States Upon Reset Release

To enter a mode capable of flashing firmware, the following pin configurations must be held when the **RES# pin** goes from Low to High:

Desired Flashing Mode	MD Pin Level	UB Pin Level	Interface Used
Boot Mode (SCI)	Low	Low	Serial (SCI1)
Boot Mode (USB)	Low	High	USB
Boot Mode (FINE)	Low → High*	Low	FINE Interface

*For FINE interface, the MD pin must be Low at reset release and then switched to High within 20 to 100 ms.

Table 17: SCI9 Firmware Configuration (MPC Settings)

Note: Pins are multiplexed. Firmware must explicitly configure the Multi-Function Pin Controller (MPC) as follows:

Step	Configuration
1. UNLOCK MPC	Unlock registers using the Write-Protect Register (PWPR)
2. PIN FUNCTION SELECT	PIN 53 (PB7) → TXD9: Set PB7PFS.PSEL[5:0] = 001010b (0x0A) PIN 54 (PB6) → RXD9: Set PB6PFS.PSEL[5:0] = 001010b (0x0A)
3. ENABLE PERIPHERAL	Set Port Mode Register (PMR) bit to '1' for both PB7 and PB6

USB-UART IC Configuration: Use Cypress configuration utility to enable BUSDETECT.

3.2 Raspberry Pi 5 Pinout

Status: Pin assignments are pending hardware verification and will be documented once validated.

3.3 Additional Peripheral Connections

Status: Peripheral connections are pending hardware verification and will be documented once validated.

4 Protocol Buffer Style Guide

This section defines naming standards and conventions for all Protocol Buffer definitions in the STAR project, following Boston Dynamics style guidelines.

4.1 Terminology Standard

The project uses inclusive terminology following OSHWA (Open Source Hardware Association) standards.

Table 18: Communication Bus Terminology

Use	Avoid	Context
Controller/Peripheral COPI CIPO Primary/Main	Master/Slave MOSI MISO Master	I2C, SPI, 1-Wire bus roles Controller Out, Peripheral In Controller In, Peripheral Out Configuration structures

4.2 Protocol Buffer Naming Conventions (Boston Dynamics Style)

The STAR project follows Boston Dynamics' Protocol Buffer style guide for all .proto definitions.

Table 19: Protocol Buffer Naming Conventions

Element	Convention	Example
Package	Versioned namespace	<code>star.v1</code>
Messages	PascalCase	<code>VelocityCommand</code> , <code>BatteryState</code>
Fields	snake_case + unit suffix	<code>velocity_mps</code> , <code>temperature_celsius</code>
Enums	SCREAMING_SNAKE_CASE	<code>MOTOR_STATE_RUNNING</code>
Enum Zero Value	_UNKNOWN suffix	<code>STATUS_UNKNOWN = 0</code>
Enum Values	Type name prefix	<code>ROBOT_MODE_MANUAL</code>
RPC Pattern	{Verb}Request/Response	<code>SetVelocityRequest</code>

4.3 Unit Suffixes (MKS System)

All numeric fields use SI units with explicit suffixes. This eliminates unit ambiguity and enables automatic documentation generation.

Table 20: Standard Unit Suffixes

Suffix	Unit	Proto Example	C Example
<code>_m</code>	meters	<code>x_m</code>	<code>distance_m</code>
<code>_mps</code>	meters/second	<code>velocity_mps</code>	<code>speed_mps</code>
<code>_mps2</code>	m/s^2	<code>accel_x_mps2</code>	<code>acceleration_mps2</code>
<code>_rad</code>	radians	<code>angle_rad</code>	<code>heading_rad</code>
<code>_rad_per_s</code>	rad/second	<code>omega_rad_per_s</code>	<code>angular_vel_rad_per_s</code>
<code>_celsius</code>	degrees C	<code>temperature_celsius</code>	<code>motor_temp_celsius</code>
<code>_deci_celsius</code>	0.1°C	<code>temp_deci_celsius</code>	(BMS native format)
<code>_us</code>	microseconds	<code>timestamp_us</code>	<code>elapsed_us</code>
<code>_ms</code>	milliseconds	<code>timeout_ms</code>	<code>period_ms</code>
<code>_ma</code>	milliamps	<code>current_ma</code>	<code>motor_current_ma</code>
<code>_mv</code>	millivolts	<code>cell_mv</code>	<code>pack_voltage_mv</code>
<code>_mw</code>	milliwatts	<code>power_mw</code>	<code>consumption_mw</code>
<code>_percent</code>	0–100%	<code>soc_percent</code>	<code>duty_cycle_percent</code>

4.4 General Documentation Standards

- Use Doxygen-compatible comments for all public APIs
- Document the “why” not just the “what”
- Keep configuration centralized in header files
- Avoid magic numbers – use named constants with comments
- Version hardware and firmware together using git tags

4.5 NASA Power of 10: Rules for Safety-Critical Code

This section documents the NASA/JPL Power of 10 coding rules developed by Gerard J. Holzmann in 2006 for safety-critical embedded systems. These rules prioritize verification and predictability over coding flexibility.

STAR Compliance Philosophy: The STAR project follows the Power of 10 rules, with one **intentional architectural deviation** for Dependency Inversion Principle (DIP) — a conscious trade-off for testability and modularity.

4.5.1 Compliance Status Legend

Symbol	Meaning
✓ COMPLIANT	STAR follows this rule
⚠ INTENTIONAL DEVIATION	Architectural choice (DIP pattern)

4.5.2 Rule 1: Simplify Control Flow

Rule: Restrict all code to very simple control flow constructs — no `goto`, `setjmp/longjmp`, or recursion (direct or indirect).

Rationale: Creates predictable program structure for human understanding and static analysis. Recursion causes unbounded stack usage — dangerous in embedded systems.

STAR Compliance: ✓ COMPLIANT

```

1  /* COMPLIANT - No goto, no recursion */
2  esp_err_t star_motor_init(star_motor_handle_t* handle,
3                          const star_motor_config_t* config)
4  {
5      if (handle == NULL || config == NULL) {
6          return ESP_ERR_INVALID_ARG;
7      }
8
9      /* All control flow uses if/while/for */
10     esp_err_t ret = configure_timer(handle, config);
11     if (ret != ESP_OK) {
12         return ret;
13     }
14
15     return configure_gpio(handle, config);
16 }

```

4.5.3 Rule 2: Fixed Loop Upper-Bounds

Rule: All loops must have a fixed upper bound that static analysis tools can trivially prove.

Rationale: Prevents runaway code, guarantees termination, enables real-time deadline verification.

STAR Compliance: ✓ COMPLIANT

```

1  /* COMPLIANT - Fixed iteration count */
2  #define MAX_RETRIES (3)
3
4  for (uint8_t i = 0; i < MAX_RETRIES; i++) {
5      if (sensor_read() == ESP_OK) {
6          break;
7      }
8      vTaskDelay(pdMS_TO_TICKS(100));
9  }
10
11 /* COMPLIANT - Array with known size */
12 #define BQ7850_MAX_CELLS (16)
13
14 for (uint8_t cell = 0; cell < BQ7850_MAX_CELLS; cell++) {
15     read_cell_voltage(cell, &voltages[cell]);
16 }

```

4.5.4 Rule 3: No Dynamic Memory After Initialization

Rule: Prohibit malloc/free after initialization phase.

Rationale: Dynamic allocation causes unpredictable performance, memory leaks, fragmentation, and corruption.

STAR Compliance: ✓ COMPLIANT

Best Practice: Use pre-allocated static pools instead of runtime memory requests.

```

1  /* COMPLIANT - Static allocation with fixed limits */
2  #define MAX_ITEMS (8)

```



```

3 #define MAX_DESC_LEN (64)
4
5 typedef struct {
6     char items[MAX_ITEMS][MAX_DESC_LEN];  /* Static 2D array */
7     uint8_t item_count;
8 } static_pool_t;
9
10 /* Usage */
11 if (pool->item_count >= MAX_ITEMS) {
12     return ESP_ERR_NO_MEM;
13 }
14 strncpy(pool->items[pool->item_count], desc, MAX_DESC_LEN - 1);
15 pool->items[pool->item_count][MAX_DESC_LEN - 1] = '\0';
16 pool->item_count++;

```

4.5.5 Rule 4: Keep Functions Short

Rule: Functions should not exceed ~60 lines (one printed page, one statement per line).

Rationale: Represents single verifiable logical units; improves comprehension, review, and testability.

STAR Compliance: ✓ **MOSTLY COMPLIANT**

```

1 /* COMPLIANT - Single responsibility, short function */
2 esp_err_t star_drv8243_read_current(star_drv8243_handle_t* handle,
3                                     float* current_ma)
4 {
5     if (handle == NULL || current_ma == NULL || !handle->initialized) {
6         return ESP_ERR_INVALID_ARG;
7     }
8
9     int raw_value = 0;
10    esp_err_t ret = read_adc_channel(handle, &raw_value);
11    if (ret != ESP_OK) {
12        return ret;
13    }
14
15    *current_ma = (float)raw_value * handle->ki_propi / 1000.0f;
16    return ESP_OK;
17 }

```

4.5.6 Rule 5: Use Assertions Generously

Rule: Minimum two assertions per function; assertions must be side-effect-free.

Rationale: Acts as executable documentation verifying pre-conditions, post-conditions, and invariants.

STAR Compliance: ✓ **COMPLIANT**

Note: STAR uses explicit parameter validation instead of assertions for production code (assertions disabled in release builds).

```

1 /* COMPLIANT - Explicit validation (better than assert for production) */
2 esp_err_t star_pid_compute(star_pid_handle_t* handle, float setpoint,
3                             float measurement, float dt, float* output)

```

```

4 {
5  /* Pre-condition checks (effectively runtime assertions) */
6  if (handle == NULL) {
7      return ESP_ERR_INVALID_ARG;
8  }
9  if (!handle->initialized) {
10     return ESP_ERR_INVALID_STATE;
11 }
12 if (output == NULL) {
13     return ESP_ERR_INVALID_ARG;
14 }
15 if (dt <= 0.0f || dt > 1.0f) { /* Sanity check time delta */
16     return ESP_ERR_INVALID_ARG;
17 }
18
19 /* Function logic */
20 float error = setpoint - measurement;
21 handle->integral += error * dt;
22
23 /* Post-condition: integral within bounds */
24 if (handle->integral > handle->integral_max) {
25     handle->integral = handle->integral_max;
26 } else if (handle->integral < handle->integral_min) {
27     handle->integral = handle->integral_min;
28 }
29
30 *output = handle->kp * error + handle->ki * handle->integral;
31 return ESP_OK;
32 }

```

4.5.7 Rule 6: Declare Data at Smallest Scope

Rule: Minimize variable scope to reduce accidental corruption risks.

Rationale: Limits chances of accidental reference or corruption from other code.

STAR Compliance: ✓ **COMPLIANT**

```

1 /* COMPLIANT - Variables declared at minimal scope */
2 void process_sensors(void)
3 {
4     /* Loop variable declared in for statement */
5     for (uint8_t i = 0; i < SENSOR_COUNT; i++) {
6         /* Temporary variable for single sensor */
7         float temp_c = 0.0f;
8         if (read_sensor(i, &temp_c) == ESP_OK) {
9             /* Process immediately, temp_c out of scope after block */
10            update_telemetry(i, temp_c);
11        }
12    }
13 }

```

4.5.8 Rule 7: Check All Return Values and Parameters

Rule: Validate all function returns and input parameters; treat warnings as errors.

Rationale: Forces explicit failure-condition handling rather than ignoring error codes.

STAR Compliance: ✓ COMPLIANT

```

1  /* COMPLIANT - All returns checked, all parameters validated */
2  esp_err_t star_bus_manager_add_bus(star_bus_manager_t* manager,
3                                     star_bus_config_t* config)
4  {
5      /* Parameter validation */
6      if (manager == NULL || config == NULL) {
7          return ESP_ERR_INVALID_ARG;
8      }
9
10     /* Check return value and propagate errors */
11     esp_err_t ret = star_bus_config_init(config);
12     if (ret != ESP_OK) {
13         ESP_LOGE(TAG, "Bus initialization failed: %s", esp_err_to_name(ret));
14         return ret;
15     }
16
17     /* Mutex operation checked */
18     if (xSemaphoreTake(manager->mutex, pdMS_TO_TICKS(1000)) != pdTRUE) {
19         ESP_LOGE(TAG, "Failed to acquire mutex");
20         return ESP_ERR_TIMEOUT;
21     }
22
23     /* Critical section */
24     add_to_list(manager, config);
25     xSemaphoreGive(manager->mutex);
26
27     return ESP_OK;
28 }

```

4.5.9 Rule 8: Limit Preprocessor Use

Rule: Restrict to header inclusion and simple macros; forbid token pasting, recursive macros, and incomplete syntactic units.

Rationale: Preprocessor complexity obscures operations, fooling developers and static analysis tools.

STAR Compliance: ✓ COMPLIANT

```

1  /* COMPLIANT - Simple constant macros */
2  #define MAX_RETRY_COUNT (3)
3  #define MOTOR_PWM_FREQ_HZ (20000)
4  #define TIMEOUT_MS (1000)
5
6  /* COMPLIANT - Simple inline functions (better than complex macros) */
7  static inline float voltage_mv_to_v(uint16_t mv)
8  {
9      return (float)mv / 1000.0f;
10 }
11
12 /* AVOID - Complex token-pasting macros */
13 // #define CREATE_HANDLER(name) handler_##name##_init() /* Too complex */

```

4.5.10 Rule 9: Restrict Pointer Use

Rule: Maximum one dereferencing level (*ptr OK, **ptr forbidden); no function pointers.

Rationale: Multiple indirection and function pointers make static data-flow analysis impossible.

STAR Compliance: ⚠ INTENTIONAL DEVIATION

Intentional Architectural Deviation: STAR uses function pointers for **Dependency Inversion Principle (DIP)** — an industry-standard pattern for testability and modularity. This is a conscious trade-off for better architecture.

DIP Pattern (Intentional Function Pointer Use):

```

1  /* INTENTIONAL DEVIATION - DIP interface with function pointers */
2  typedef struct star_error_interface {
3      esp_err_t (*record_error)(void* ctx, esp_err_t error, const char*
4          message,
5          const char* file, int line, const char* func);
6      bool (*can_retry)(void* ctx);
7      esp_err_t (*reset_state)(void* ctx);
8      void* ctx; /* Implementation context */
9  } star_error_interface_t;
10
11 /* Why we keep this:
12  * 1. Enables mock implementations for unit testing
13  * 2. Allows swapping error handlers without recompilation
14  * 3. Follows SOLID principles (Dependency Inversion)
15  * 4. Industry-standard pattern (used in Linux kernel, RTOS, etc.)
16  */

```

4.5.11 Rule 10: Compile with Maximum Warnings

Rule: Enable all compiler warnings at highest pedantry; achieve zero-warning builds with static analyzers.

Rationale: Modern compilers catch bugs before runtime. Zero warnings, no excuses.

STAR Compliance: ✓ COMPLIANT

```

1  # platformio.ini - Compiler flags
2  build_flags =
3      -Wall                # Enable all warnings
4      -Wextra              # Extra warnings
5      -Werror              # Treat warnings as errors
6      -Wno-unused-parameter # Allow unused params in interface
7                          implementations
8      -Wno-missing-field-initializers

```

CI/CD Enforcement: Build fails on any compiler warning.

4.5.12 Summary: STAR Compliance Matrix

Table 21: NASA Power of 10 Compliance Status

Rule	Description	STAR Status
1	No <code>goto</code> /recursion	✓ COMPLIANT
2	Fixed loop bounds	✓ COMPLIANT
3	No dynamic memory	✓ COMPLIANT
4	Short functions (<60 lines)	✓ COMPLIANT
5	Use assertions	✓ COMPLIANT
6	Minimal variable scope	✓ COMPLIANT
7	Check all returns	✓ COMPLIANT
8	Limit preprocessor	✓ COMPLIANT
9	Restrict pointers	△! INTENTIONAL (DIP)
10	Maximum warnings	✓ COMPLIANT

4.5.13 References

- Holzmann, Gerard J. *“The Power of 10: Rules for Developing Safety-Critical Code.”* IEEE Computer, 39(6), pp. 95-97, June 2006.
- JPL Institutional Coding Standard for the C Programming Language (JPL DOCID D-60411)
- MISRA C:2012 Guidelines for the Use of the C Language in Critical Systems

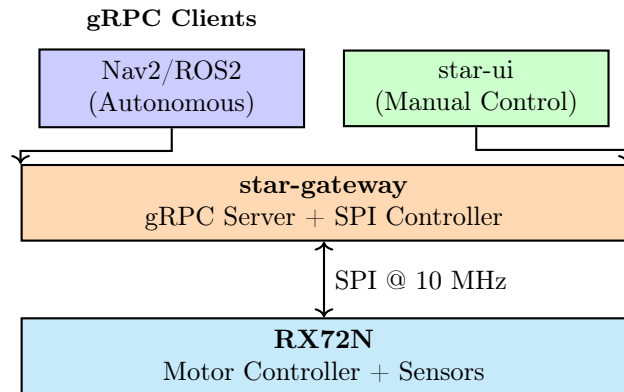
5 Gateway Architecture

This section documents the `star-gateway` Go service that bridges the Raspberry Pi 5 control stack with the RX72N motor controller.

5.1 Overview

The gateway service runs on the Raspberry Pi 5 and serves as the communication bridge between:

- **High-level side:** gRPC clients (Nav2/ROS2 for autonomous navigation, UI for manual control)
- **Low-level side:** RX72N motor controller via SPI at 10 MHz



5.2 Protocol Stack Implementation

The gateway implements Layers 1–4 of the communication protocol (see Section 1.2.1).

Table 22: Gateway Protocol Stack Implementation

Layer	Name	Go Package	Status
5	Application	<code>internal/service/</code>	Placeholder
4	Serialization	<code>star-proto/gen/go/</code>	Generated
3	ARQ	<code>internal/arq/</code>	Placeholder
2	Framing	<code>internal/frame/</code>	Implemented
1	Transport	<code>internal/transport/</code>	Placeholder

5.3 Directory Structure

```

star-gateway/
+-- cmd/
|   +-- star-gateway/
|       +-- main.go           # Entry point
+-- internal/
|   +-- transport/           # Layer 1: SPI transport
|       | +-- spi.go         # Transport interface
|       | +-- spi_test.go
|   +-- frame/               # Layer 2: Frame protocol
|       | +-- frame.go       # Constants and types
  
```

```

| | +-- encoder.go          # Frame encoder
| | +-- decoder.go         # Frame decoder
| | +-- frame_test.go
| +-- arq/                 # Layer 3: ARQ protocol
| | +-- arq.go             # Stop-and-Wait ARQ
| | +-- arq_test.go
| +-- service/             # Layer 5: gRPC services
|   +-- motor_control.go
|   +-- telemetry.go
|   +-- battery.go
|   +-- configuration.go
|   +-- firmware.go
+-- go.mod
+-- CLAUDE.md

```

5.4 Frame Package

The `internal/frame` package defines the wire protocol constants and types.

5.4.1 Frame Constants

Table 23: Frame Protocol Constants

Constant	Value	Description
SyncWord	0x55AA	Frame sync marker (alternating bits: [0x55, 0xAA])
SyncSize	2 bytes	Sync word size
HeaderSize	6 bytes	SEQ(2) + LEN(2) + TYPE(1) + FLAGS(1)
CRCSize	4 bytes	CRC-32 checksum
MaxPayloadSize	1024 bytes	Maximum protobuf payload
MaxFrameSize	1036 bytes	Total frame size
MinFrameSize	12 bytes	Empty payload frame

5.4.2 Frame Types

- `FrameTypeCommand` – Command from controller to peripheral
- `FrameTypeResponse` – Response from peripheral to controller
- `FrameTypeAck` – Acknowledgment of successful receipt
- `FrameTypeNack` – Negative acknowledgment (CRC error, etc.)

5.5 Transport Package

The `internal/transport` package provides the SPI transport layer.

5.5.1 SPI Configuration

Table 24: SPI Configuration Constants

Parameter	Value	Description
Device	/dev/spidev0.0	SPI device path
Speed	10 MHz	SPI clock frequency
Mode	0	CPOL=0, CPHA=0
Bits per word	8	Word size
Timeout	100 ms	Default operation timeout

5.5.2 Transport Interface

```

type Transport interface {
    Send(data []byte) (int, error)
    Receive(maxLen int) ([]byte, error)
    Transfer(txData []byte) ([]byte, error)
    Close() error
}

```

5.6 ARQ Package

The `internal/arq` package implements Stop-and-Wait ARQ for reliable delivery.

5.6.1 ARQ Parameters

Table 25: ARQ Protocol Parameters

Parameter	Value	Description
Max Retries	3	Maximum transmission attempts
Timeout	10 ms	ACK wait timeout
Sequence Max	0xFFFF	16-bit wraparound

5.6.2 ARQ State Machine

- **IDLE** – Ready to send or receive
- **WAITING_ACK** – Waiting for acknowledgment
- **RETRANSMITTING** – Retransmitting after timeout/NACK
- **ERROR** – Max retries exceeded

5.7 gRPC Services

The gateway exposes five gRPC services (see Section 2.2 for detailed specifications):

Table 26: Gateway gRPC Services

Service	Purpose
MotorControlService	Differential drive control, encoder streaming
TelemetryService	IMU, GPS, system status
BatteryManagementService	BQ7850 BMS monitoring
ConfigurationService	Runtime parameters, NVS persistence

5.8 Build and Test

```
# Build the gateway binary
cd star-gateway
go build ./cmd/star-gateway
```

```
# Run all tests
go test ./...
```

```
# Run with verbose output
go test -v ./...
```

```
# Format code
go fmt ./...
```

```
# Static analysis
go vet ./...
```

5.9 Dependencies

The gateway depends on:

- github.com/Locked-Inc/star-proto/gen/go – Generated protobuf and gRPC code
- google.golang.org/grpc – gRPC framework
- google.golang.org/protobuf – Protocol Buffers runtime

The `go.work` file at the repository root enables workspace mode for seamless cross-module development:

```
go 1.21
```

```
use (
    ./star-proto/gen/go
    ./star-proto/tests/go
    ./star-gateway
)
```